

Refactoring an ox-hugo site for newer orgmode

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On newer versions of `orgmode` (i.e. anything `9.7` or newer) something upstream breaks the manner in which `ox-hugo` handles links for sub-tree exports^[^fn:1]. The most robust workaround is to stop using native Org links and switch to a manual Hugo short-code via an Org macro.

The process has two parts. First, we need the `relref` macro in the Org file with `#+macro: relref @@hugo:[$1]({< relref "$2" >})@@` ^[^fn:2].

Then every internal link needs to be refactored using the target file slug, optionally appending the anchor if required.

Before:

```
As I mentioned in my [[On-boarding for Code in Place][last post]]...
```

After:

```
As I mentioned in my {{{relref(last post,scp-onboarding)}}}, I'm leading a section...
```

I ended up starting with a manual conversion, which was very tedious, but does result in a more stable site with links that are properly managed by Hugo's content engine, insulating the site from future Org mode changes.

Eventually I used [a script](#) to generate most of the `relref` changes, with the exception of titles with code snippets:

```
pixi s
python ./scripts/convert_links.py content-org/all-posts.org all-posts-converted.org
```

Update [2026-07-10 Fri]

The `ox-hugo` same-file cross-post failure under Org 9.7+ is fixed in the exporter (path/search-option split + restoring `file:` after interpret). This site loads that fix from `setup/vendor/ox-hugo.el`. Internal post links in `content-org/all-posts.org` were converted back to normal Org links (`[[Post title][description]]`); reverse of the `relref` macro conversion above via `scripts/convert_relref_to_org_links.py`. The historical workaround text in this snippet is unchanged.